

Bahu Manaratha translation

Dear friend, with a lot of hope I dressed up for this journey. A blue dress, kohl in the eyes, paint on the lips, and flowers in the hair. Because this journey, do you hear, was for my lover. All the joy that you ever desire, where else would you find it if not in love?

The banks of Yamuna have dense dark forests. My lover, that's where he waited for me. He waited inspite of the pain he suffered. This journey, do you hear, was to those banks. The prolonged wait was finally going to end in our union. Friend, this is the joy that you desire, where else would you find it if not in love?

But dear friend, I was unfortunate. I've always been so. I spent the entire night on the banks; awake and alone. My lover didn't show up. Every bit of the anticipation was now replaced with the weight of exhaustion. Perhaps, this always had to be.

Could I ever tell you what this journey cost me? The adversities, the struggle, the sacrifices? And the hopes? That night, as the Kajal flowed down my face like dark streams of tears, I burned in anger and shame. Mohan, I despise you. Why did I ever embark on this journey? Is this what love is for - bearing disappointment and shame?

Dear friend, I still dress up everyday. A blue dress, kohl in the eyes, paint on the lips, and flowers in the hair. I dress up without hope. Everyday I set on the same journey to the banks of Yamuna. Mohan has perhaps moved way beyond these dense dark forests. But my friend, all the pain that you ever desire, where else would you find it, if not in love?